TikTok

12% of budget · AED 26/day per ad at full tier · cheap reach, open question

The lowest CPMs available in this market by a wide margin, and a genuine founder-content advantage. Lower intent than Meta, so treat its output as a retargeting pool first and a pipeline second.

Whether TikTok produces B2B leads in the UAE at all is a real open question. This budget is sized to answer it, not to bet on it.

Where to build it

TikTok Ads Manager → **Campaign** → Create → **Website conversions**. Use Custom mode, not Simplified — you need placement and schedule control.

Campaign level

SETTING	VALUE
Objective	Website conversions
Budget	AED 26/day per ad group
Optimisation event	Complete registration (mapped to your lead event)

Ad group level

SETTING	VALUE
Placement	TikTok only. **Turn off Pangle and News Feed App series**
Location	United Arab Emirates
Age	25–55
Interests / behaviours	**None**
Schedule	**Dayparting: 20:00–00:00 GST**
Bid strategy	Lowest cost

Turn Pangle off. It is TikTok's third-party app network — cheap traffic that converts poorly for B2B and will flatter your CPM while poisoning your lead quality. This is the single most important setting on this page.

On the evening schedule. Gulf social usage peaks late. More than that: Ad 2 depicts an enquiry arriving at 23:04 to a closed office. A business owner seeing it at 23:04, on a phone, in bed, is being shown their own situation as it is happening — and late-night inventory is among the cheapest of the day. The best-converting slot and the cheapest slot are the same slot.

The ads

Both are 1080×1920, narrated, with captions burned in.

Ad 1 — Scrolling the Spreadsheet · `ad-01-scrolling-the-spreadsheet.mp4`

32.6s. A screen recording of the actual timing spreadsheet. No face, no studio. The blank cells in the reply column are the payoff.

Ad text (80 char max)

```
{{N_TIMED}} Dubai businesses. One Tuesday. {{N_NEVER_REPLIED}} never replied.
```

Call to action — Learn more

Ad 2 — The 11pm Lead · `ad-02-the-11pm-lead.mp4`

31.9s. A lock screen at 23:04, an enquiry arriving, the office closed, a reply at 09:12 — and a competitor who answered at 23:06. Every number in it is measured or dramatised without naming a real business, so it ships today.

Ad text

```
Your ads run at 11pm. Your team doesn't. That gap is the whole problem.
```

Call to action — Learn more

Music

Neither video carries a music bed, deliberately. **Add a trending sound in TikTok's own editor before publishing** — organic trending audio consistently outperforms anything baked in, and TikTok's algorithm treats it as a positive signal. Keep it low enough that the narration stays clear.

Week one — what good looks like

METRIC	EXPECTED BAND
CPM	$4–8
CTR	0.7–1.1%
Cost per lead	$18–40
Qualified rate	~30%
3-second view rate	above 20%

If the 3-second view rate is under 20%, the opening frame is failing — not the story. Re-cut the hook, keep everything else.

The verdict this platform owes you

By week 6, one of three things is true:

1. **Qualified rate above 30%** — this is an acquisition channel. Scale it.
2. **Qualified rate 15–30%** — this is an awareness channel. Keep it running at a low budget and feed its traffic into Meta retargeting, where it converts.
3. **Under 15%** — stop. Move the budget to Meta. You learned something cheaply.

All three are useful answers. The failure is running it for eight weeks without deciding which one happened.

Mistakes specific to this platform

- **Leaving Pangle on.** Named twice on purpose.
- **Polished production.** The unpolished screen recording is the concept. A studio version of Ad 1 would perform worse.
- **No captions.** Both already have them burned in. Do not remove them in favour of TikTok's auto-captions, which sit in the wrong place.
- **Running all day.** Daypart to evenings. Daytime inventory here is expensive relative to its intent.
- **Judging it by Meta's numbers.** Different funnel position, different job.

Before this ad can run at all

Five things are missing site-side and no ad on any platform works without the first two:

1. **Conversion tracking.** This platform's pixel, plus GA4. Without it the campaign optimises on clicks, which is the metric least connected to money.
2. **The landing page.** `/leak-test` — one field (website URL + email), wired to the CRM. The ads all point here.
3. **Ad account + domain verification.** Meta's domain verification is the longest-lead item of the whole launch; start it first.
4. **Currency decided.** The site prices in USD, the internal docs in EUR, the strategy in AED. Pick AED for this market and make ads, page and checkout agree.
5. **Fulfilment staffed.** The offer is a free report inside 24 working hours. This campaign sells speed of response to people you have just taught to measure speed of response. If nobody is assigned to produce the reports, run a smaller budget rather than a slower promise.

Two rules that apply everywhere

Never edit a running ad that is performing. Editing resets the learning phase and throws away everything the algorithm knows. Launch the new version alongside it and let the old one die. Pausing is free; editing is not.

Never sum conversions across platforms. Meta's 7-day window and LinkedIn's 30-day window measure different things and both will claim the same lead. Report side by side and reconcile against the CRM monthly.

When they disagree, the CRM wins.

Kyntlo creative batch 2026-10. Performance bands are expected ranges for UAE targeting, not commitments — recalibrate against your own first thirty days.
